

Iowa ARNG Child and Youth Program Data Trends Report

Year over year program and social media analysis

This report summarizes the corrected annual program totals available for FY20 through FY26 and Facebook records available in the September 21, 2026 database pull. The strongest finding is that FY26 youth attendance increased to 8,188 while recent Facebook content also maintained its best recorded engagement levels.

620.8% FY26 YOUTH INCREASE	160.5 FY26 YOUTH PER EVENT	8,188 FY26 YOUTH ATTENDANCE	51 FY26 COMPLETED EVENTS
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Executive findings

FY26 is the strongest youth-attendance year in the corrected series. Youth attendance increased from 1,136 in FY25 to 8,188 in FY26. The increase of 7,052 youth represents 620.8 percent year-over-year growth.

Reach increased much faster than event volume. Completed or reporting-complete events increased from 43 to 51, an 18.6 percent rise. Youth per event increased from 26.4 to 160.5. This identifies where the change occurred, but event-level analysis is still needed to determine which activities drove it.

Facebook engagement improved after 2024. Total engagement rose 31.7 percent in 2025 while posting volume increased only 6.8 percent. Engagement per post increased from 10.6 to 13.1, indicating that the improvement was not explained by posting frequency alone.

2026 social performance remains strong. Through September 16, the page recorded 122 posts and 1,802 engagements. That is already 97 percent of the engagement recorded during all of 2025, with average engagement at 14.8 per post.

FY26 also records more programming time. Program hours increased from 240.8 in FY25 to 311.5 in FY26, a 29.4 percent increase. Families served increased from 626 to 690, or 10.2 percent.

Annual program performance

The corrected annual totals distinguish youth attendance from total attendance and count only completed or reporting-complete events. Youth reach remained between 1,118 and 1,862 from FY20 through FY25, then increased sharply in FY26.

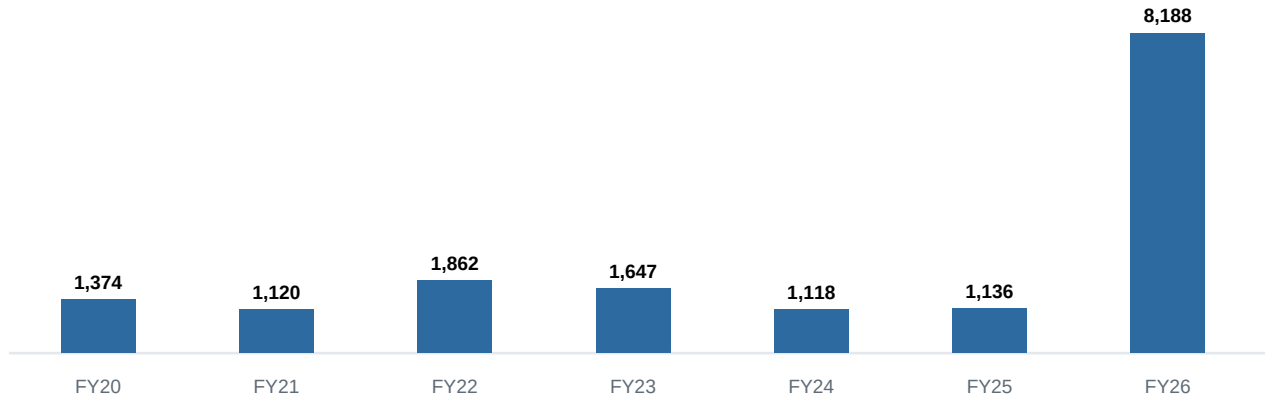


Figure 1 Annual recorded youth attendance

Fiscal year	Events	Attendance	Attendance per event	Program hours	Families served
FY20	67	1,374	20.5	138.8	374
FY21	42	1,120	26.7	276.5	1,809
FY22	51	1,862	36.5	367.0	1,209
FY23	41	1,647	40.2	243.0	1,499
FY24	36	1,118	31.1	273.2	563
FY25	43	1,136	26.4	240.8	626
FY26	51	8,188	160.5	311.5	690

Program interpretation

FY21 recorded fewer youth than FY20 but nearly twice as many program hours. FY22 youth attendance rose 66.3 percent to 1,862, the strongest result before FY26. FY23 retained the highest pre-FY26 youth-per-event rate at 40.2, then youth attendance declined to 1,118 in FY24.

FY25 was relatively stable, with youth attendance increasing 1.6 percent to 1,136. Completed events increased from 36 to 43 while program hours fell from 273.3 to 240.8. Youth per event therefore declined from 31.1 to 26.4.

FY26 changes the trajectory. The live database reports 51 completed or reporting-complete events, 8,188 youth, and 311.5 program hours. Youth attendance is more than four times the previous high of 1,862 in FY22. The magnitude warrants event-level verification and documentation of which large-reach activities contributed to the total.

Facebook activity and engagement

The Facebook archive contains 1,406 posts beginning in 2011. Posting increased gradually through 2015, reached a temporary high in 2020, declined during 2021 and 2022, and accelerated again during 2024 and 2025.

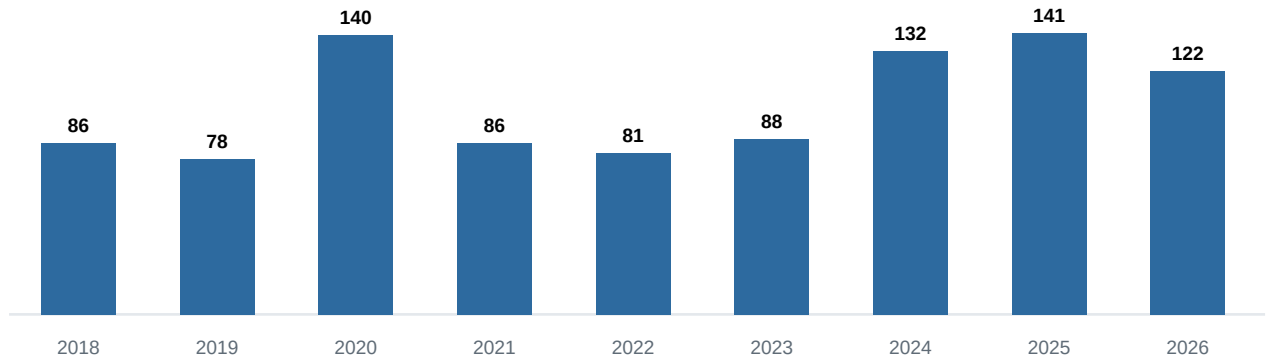


Figure 2 Facebook posts from 2018 through 2026

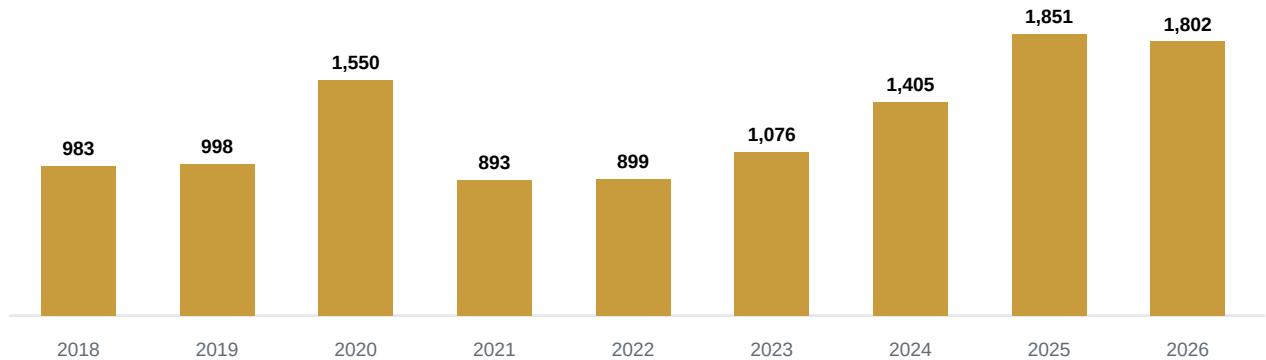


Figure 3 Recorded Facebook engagement from 2018 through 2026

The 2024 to 2025 comparison is the most useful completed-year signal. Posts rose from 132 to 141, while engagement rose from 1,405 to 1,851. Average engagement improved from 10.6 to 13.1 per post. This suggests stronger content performance, although the data does not identify a single cause.

The 2026 record is partial through September 16. At that point, engagement had nearly matched the 2025 annual total and average engagement had risen to 14.8 per post. If the remaining months follow a similar pattern, 2026 is positioned to exceed 2025, but this report does not project a final value.

Annual Facebook measures

Year	Posts	Engagement	Engagement per post	Recorded views
2011	6	9	1.5	0
2012	16	18	1.1	0
2013	61	33	0.5	2
2014	72	49	0.7	21
2015	110	112	1.0	3
2016	102	391	3.8	26
2017	85	536	6.3	72
2018	86	983	11.4	131
2019	78	998	12.8	145
2020	140	1,550	11.1	229
2021	86	893	10.4	465
2022	81	899	11.1	373
2023	88	1,076	12.2	1,674
2024	132	1,405	10.6	25,402
2025	141	1,851	13.1	130,441
2026	122	1,802	14.8	95,681

Follower growth

The reliable measured follower series begins in 2024. Followers increased from 1,693 at the end of 2024 to 1,763 at the end of 2025, a gain of 70. The page reached 1,834 followers by September 16, 2026, adding another 71 followers during the partial year.

Recorded views

Recorded views increased sharply from 1,674 in 2023 to 25,402 in 2024 and 130,441 in 2025. This series should not be used as a direct long-term growth comparison because Meta's historical metric availability changed. Recent view totals remain useful for current-period monitoring when the same collection method is used.

Management implications

The data supports four practical management priorities.

- **Document the FY26 reach drivers.** Identify the event categories, locations, delivery methods, and large-reach activities that account for the increase to 8,188 youth.
- **Track youth reach per unit of effort.** Use youth per event and youth per program hour alongside total activity counts. This makes it easier to distinguish greater reach from greater workload.
- **Preserve recent communication practices.** Review the content and timing of the highest-engagement posts from 2025 and 2026, then use those patterns to guide future publishing.
- **Standardize reporting definitions.** Document how families served, participants, and program hours are counted. Consistent definitions will improve future year-over-year comparisons.

Interview discussion summary

The corrected data shows that FY26 produced the strongest recorded youth reach in the series. Youth attendance rose to 8,188 across 51 completed or reporting-complete events, while program hours increased to 311.5. Recent digital engagement also remained strong. The next management opportunity is to document which activities produced that reach and use the evidence to guide future programming and communication.

Data scope and limitations

Program totals cover FY20 through FY26 and were pulled on September 21, 2026. The FY26 figures include 51 completed or reporting-complete events; the fiscal year has not yet ended. Raw database rows may include cancelled, planned, or incomplete events that are excluded from the reporting total. Youth attendance comes from the annual youth view and should not be compared with earlier reports that combined youth and adult attendance. Facebook engagement reflects the metrics returned by the Meta Graph API. Historical reach is unavailable, and historical views are not consistently comparable. Follower snapshots before 2024 use the oldest available follower value and do not represent measured annual follower history. Historical Page Likes are unavailable through the current Meta API.

Family totals show large changes between years. The report preserves those recorded values but does not assume that the definition remained constant. Findings describe association and observed change; they do not establish causation.

Source

Iowa CYP administrative reporting records in Supabase, including the annual youth view, completed event records, activity logs, and Facebook page snapshots. Database pull completed September 21, 2026.